



BWF

Instructions to Umpires & Service Judges

November 2021

Introduction

These instructions have been produced with the aim of providing all umpires across the world with guidance to aid personal development in umpiring and service judging, enhance the presentation of badminton and promote consistency in officiating any level of tournament or competition.

Uniform

- ◀ Appearance is important at all times.
- ◀ Always wear the BWF Uniform or that provided by the host organiser for all umpires at a tournament.
- ◀ Black trousers/skirts are preferred for female umpires (not jeans or casual wear) – worn with smart black shoes.

Before the Match - Off Court

- ▶ Umpire, service judge, together with the line judges and court attendants (if available), should assemble at the designated area, generally 15 minutes before the start time of a match.
- ▶ Umpire should ensure that he/she has the full complement of line judges and court attendants (if applicable).

Before the Match - Off Court

- ▶ Each court will have designated entry and exit locations - which would have been made known at the main Umpires' Briefing.
- ▶ Ensure that all members of the technical officials team are aware of these locations.
- ▶ Prior to walking on court with other court officials and players, ensure that the players' clothing complies with the tournament regulations, as instructed by the referee at the main Umpires' Briefing.
- ▶ If you have a mobile phone, switch it off.

Before the Match - Off Court

- ▶ To assist with the correct announcement of players' names, umpires can ask a coach, team member or umpiring colleague, prior to going on court.
- ▶ Umpires can write the names on the scoresheet in their own language.

Before the Match - Off/On Court

- ▶ Under the instructions given, the umpire should lead their team of officials onto the Field Of Play (FOP).
- ▶ Order onto the FOP will generally be umpire, players, service judge, line judges then court attendants.
- ▶ Walk at a pace that others in the team can follow, bearing in mind those who may find it difficult to walk fast.
- ▶ Walk onto the court professionally at the designated entry point and stand on the singles line of the court with your back to the umpire's chair.

Before the Match - On Court

- ▶ Umpire to stand with their feet on either side of the short service line and the service judge to stand nearest the net.
- ▶ Hands can be clasped as shown in picture, or behind your back.



Before the Match - On Court

- ▶ After the umpire and service judge shake hands with the players, prior to the toss, the service judge immediately goes across the court to the opposite side of the net, stands in front of the service judge's chair and has a shuttle(s) ready for the players to warm up.
- ▶ To conduct the toss, the umpire takes one step further into the court.
- ▶ Ensure players do not warm up during the coin toss, particularly in doubles, and that all the players are on the umpire's side of the court.

Before the Match - On Court

- ▶ Do not turn around and face the umpire's chair while conducting the toss.
- ▶ Do not let the coin drop to the floor.
- ▶ Clearly indicate who has won the toss.



Before the Match - On Court

- ▶ The umpire should get into the umpire's chair immediately after the toss. Do not touch the players' bags or boxes.
- ▶ The two minute warm-up starts when the umpire sits in the umpire's chair, and it ends with "Love all, play".
- ▶ Take a moment to look around the court to ensure that everything is correct.
- ▶ The service judge should only sit down once the umpire is in his/her chair.

Before the Match - On Court

- ◀ Where an electronic scorepad is in use, the stop watch on the pad should be used.
- ◀ Where an electronic scorepad is not in use, the umpire should use a stopwatch or wrist watch, and have it ready to record any interruption of play such as injury, suspension of play, etc.
- ◀ The umpire should not have the stopwatch hanging round his/her neck. A wrist watch is preferred.
- ◀ The yellow and red cards should not be visible.

Scoresheet

- ▶ Use an open-ended method where the numbers of the score are written down after each rally.
- ▶ The score is entered in a double row of boxes (one row for each playing side) with only one score per vertical pair of boxes.
- ▶ Each vertical pair represents one rally. This gives an easy-to-read method to determine which side has won the rally and the right to serve (as the serving side is always the one with the score at the front except at the beginning of the game i.e. ahead by one vertical block).

Scoresheet

- ▶ If a game fills one double row, the scores are continued on the next double row.
- ▶ The score should be entered with clear precise numbers.
- ▶ Remember, the scoresheet is a tool to assist the umpire and even in a moment of “panic” when the exact situation is not clearly remembered, the scoresheet must be as legible as possible, to reduce the chances of making an error.
- ▶ It also should assist the referee to make a decision in case of an appeal.

Scoresheet

In singles:

Player A	S	0	1				2	3	4				5	6			7	8		9
Player B		0		1	2	3				4	5	6			7	8			9	

In doubles:



Player A							2	3	4								7	8		
Player B	S	0	1										5	6						9
Player C				1	2	3									7	8				
Player D	R	0								4	5	6							9	

(Write the score first, then announce the score with your head up so your voice projects.)

Scoresheet

Pre-match Details

- ◀ To be completed (if not completed by computer) once you are given the scoresheet, before going on-court.

Preliminaries

- ◀ "S" and "R" – server and receiver should be filled in when conducting toss, after the sides have exercised their choice. In singles, mark the server only.

Scoresheet

- ▶ “L” / “R” – left/right indicate placement of the players when starting, viewed from the umpire’s chair. Fill this in when conducting toss, after the side has exercised their choice of the end.
- ▶ “0” – mark against initial server and initial receiver at the start of each game.
- ▶ Start time – note the time when the umpire announces “Play” at the beginning of a match.
- ▶ Note the shuttles used during a match, including the warm-up shuttle(s).

Scoresheet

During Play

- ◀ Write the new score in the next available box, in the row of the next server's name.
- ◀ In doubles, the players of the receiving side shall not change their respective service courts until they win a point on their service.
- ◀ Thus, when a side loses the right to serve, the player who was serving at that time, shall continue to be in the same service court from where he last served, until his side gains right to serve again and wins a point.

Scoresheet

Example (refer to slide 15):

- ◀ In doubles, Player D serves from right service court when the score was 6-4, and their side loses the rally. Player D will continue to be on the right service court, until his/her side wins a point and gains the right to serve again. Thus, when the score becomes 7-6, Player C will serve from the left service court.

Scoresheet

- ▶ If the receiving side wins the point to make it “service over”, write their new score in the next available box (last completed box is always the side serving).
- ▶ Score levelled at 20-all – draw diagonal line on the next available box.
- ▶ If situations listed in the table occur, use the appropriate alphabet(s) in the next available box of the appropriate player.

Situation	Alphabet to be used
Warning (for misconduct)	W
Fault (for misconduct)	F
Referee called on court	R
Suspension	S
Injury	I
Disqualified by the Referee	Dis
Retired	Ret
Service court error corrected	C
Over-rule of Line Judge Call	O

Scoresheet

- ◀ If a match has to be suspended, note "S" on the server's line.
- ◀ If the umpire overrules a line judge's call during a match, note "O" immediately above or below the score, as appropriate.
- ◀ If a service court error is corrected, note "C" against the side who committed the error, and mark it above or below (as the case may be) the score at which the error is corrected.

Scoresheet

- ▶ If misconduct occurs during the interval between games, write the corresponding letter of the alphabet ("W" or "F") into the next available box on the line of the offending player(s) following the completed game score.
- ▶ However, in the case where a red card is issued the new score shall be noted following 0-0 in the next game.

Scoresheet

End of a Game

- ◀ Write and circle completed game score with a slash between the score.
- ◀ Fill in completed game score at top of the scoresheet.
- ◀ Note "S", and "R", in case of doubles, for the start of the next game.
- ◀ Mark in "0" against initial server and initial receiver at the start of the next game.

Scoresheet

End of a Match

- ◀ Write and circle completed game score.
- ◀ End time – write the time the match ends, i.e. when umpire calls “Game”, at the end of the game which decides the match.
- ◀ Fill in complete game scores at top of the scoresheet.
- ◀ Circle name(s) of the player(s) of the winning side at the top of the scoresheet.

Scoresheet

Post-Match

- ▶ Duration – calculate and write the duration of the match after leaving the Field Of Play (FOP).
- ▶ Write appropriate details about the situations (listed in table on slide 20), at the bottom of the scoresheet. If the space is not sufficient, write on the back of the scoresheet, with a specific remark on the front indicating “For remarks please refer to the back of the scoresheet”.
- ▶ Sign the completed scoresheet, obtain a counter-signature from the referee, and hand it over to Match Control.

Scoresheet -Example

EXAMPLE 1

Event: XD

No. R16 - # 19

Date: 14 Feb 2021

Time: 16:00

R

Player A

Player B

Member Name

Score

21	:	10
----	---	----

22	:	20
----	---	----

□ □

Player C

Player D

Member Name

L

Shuttles: 9

Court: 3

Umpire: Name

Service Judge: Name

Start Match: 16:06

End Match: 16:46

Duration (Min): 40

Player A												5	6	7	8	9	10	11											18	19						
Player B		S	0	1	2	3	4														12	13	14	15	16	17								20	21	
Player C								1	2	3	4																7	8		C						
Player D		R	0								O									5	6								C				9	10		

[illegible][illegible][illegible][illegible][illegible]

S - Match suspended in the second game for 4 minutes 30 seconds due to power failure

C - Service court error corrected

O - Over-rule of Line Judge call

Umpire.....

Referee

Scoresheet - Example

EXAMPLE 2

Event: MS
No. R16 - # 24
Date: 14 Feb 2021
Time: 16:00

R	Player A
	Member Name

Score		
30	:	29
19	:	21
16	:	21

L	Player B
	Member Name

Shuttles: 20

Court: 2
Umpire: Name
Service Judge: Name
Start Match: 16:10
End Match: 17:10
Duration (Min): 60

Player A		S	0	1	2			3	4			5	6	7		8	9				10	11			12	13			14	15	16				17
Player B			0			1	2			3	4				5			6	7	8			9	10			11	12				13	14	15	

Player A			18	19	20						21		22		23		24		25		26		27		28		29		30		30			
Player B						16	17	18	19	20			21		22		23		24		25		26		27		28		29		29			

Player A		S	0				1	2	3					4	5	6	7					8	9	10	11			12	13				14	15	
Player B			0	1	2	3				4	5	6	7					8	9	10	11					12	13			14	15	16			17

Player A				W	16	17		18		19		19																						
Player B			18				19		20		21	21																						

Player A			0			1	2	3	4	5				6	7	8					9	10	11					12	F					13	14		
Player B		S	0	1	2						3	4	5			6	7	8	9					10	11	12			R			13	14	15	16		17

Player A					15		16				16																								
Player B			18			19		20	21		21																								

W - Player A warned for influencing the Line Judge
F/R - Player A faulted for using abusive language. Referee was called on court and instructed Umpire to observe and fault again if necessary.

Umpire: Referee:

Scoresheet - Example

EXAMPLE 3

Event: WS
No. SF - # 30
Date: 15 Feb 2021
Time: 14:00

L

Player A

Member Name

Score

15 : 21

4 : 6

: Ret

Player B

Member Name

R

Shuttles: 5

Court: 1

Umpire: Name

Service Judge: Name

Start Match: 14:10

End Match: 14:28

Duration (Min): 18

Player A		0			1	2	3	4		5	6			7	8		9	10				11	12		13		
Player B	S	0	1	2	3				4	5	6	7	8	9	10		11		12	13	14	15		16	17	18	19
Player A		14	15				15																				
Player B				20	I	21	21																				
					R																						
Player A		0			1	2	3	4					4														
Player B	S	0	1	2					3	4	5	6	I	Ret	6												
Player A																											
Player B																											
Player A																											
Player B																											
Player A																											
Player B																											

I/R - Player B had a nose bleed. Referee and Tournament Doctor were called on court. Game delayed for 8 minutes

I/Ret - Player B twisted her ankle and decided to retire.

Umpire.....Referee

Scoresheet - Example

EXAMPLE 4

Event: MD

No. R32 - # 4

Date: 13 Feb 2021

Time: 11:00

L	Player A
	Player B
	Member Name

Score	
21	: 23
8	: 7
	: Dis

Player C	R
Player D	
Member Name	

Shuttles: 9

Court: 4

Umpire: Name

Service Judge: Name

Start Match: 11:05

End Match: 11:29

Duration (Min): 24

Player A					1					4				7	8	9									13	14				
Player B		S	0					2	3				5	6					10	11	12							15		16
Player C				1	2					4	5				7	8							11	12	13	14				W
Player D		R	0				3					6						9	10								15			
Player A						18	19					21			21		F													
Player B			17							20							R													
Player C				16	17						20																			
Player D							18	19					21	22	23		23													
Player A		R	0				2				4				6															
Player B					1					3			5			7		8												
Player C		S	0	1				3				5				7		R												
Player D						2				4				6				F		Dis										
Player A																														
Player B																														
Player C																														
Player D																														
Player A																														
Player B																														
Player C																														
Player D																														
Player A																														
Player B																														
Player C																														
Player D																														

W - Player C warned for interfering with the shuttle

F/R - Player A was faulted during the interval after the 1st game for kicking down the A-board. Referee was called on court and instructed to observe and fault again if necessary.

F/R/Dis - Player D was faulted for pushing the Line Judge. Referee was called on court and decided to disqualify the player

Umpire.....

Referee.....

Before the Match - On Court

- ▶ At 90 seconds, call "Ready to play" - this indicates to the players and spectators that the match is about to start.
- ▶ Check that players' equipment, bags, rackets, water bottles, towels, etc. are in the designated boxes or baskets near the umpire's chair. Nothing should hang out of the boxes or over the A-boards. However, it is ok for spare racket(s) to lie on top of the box.

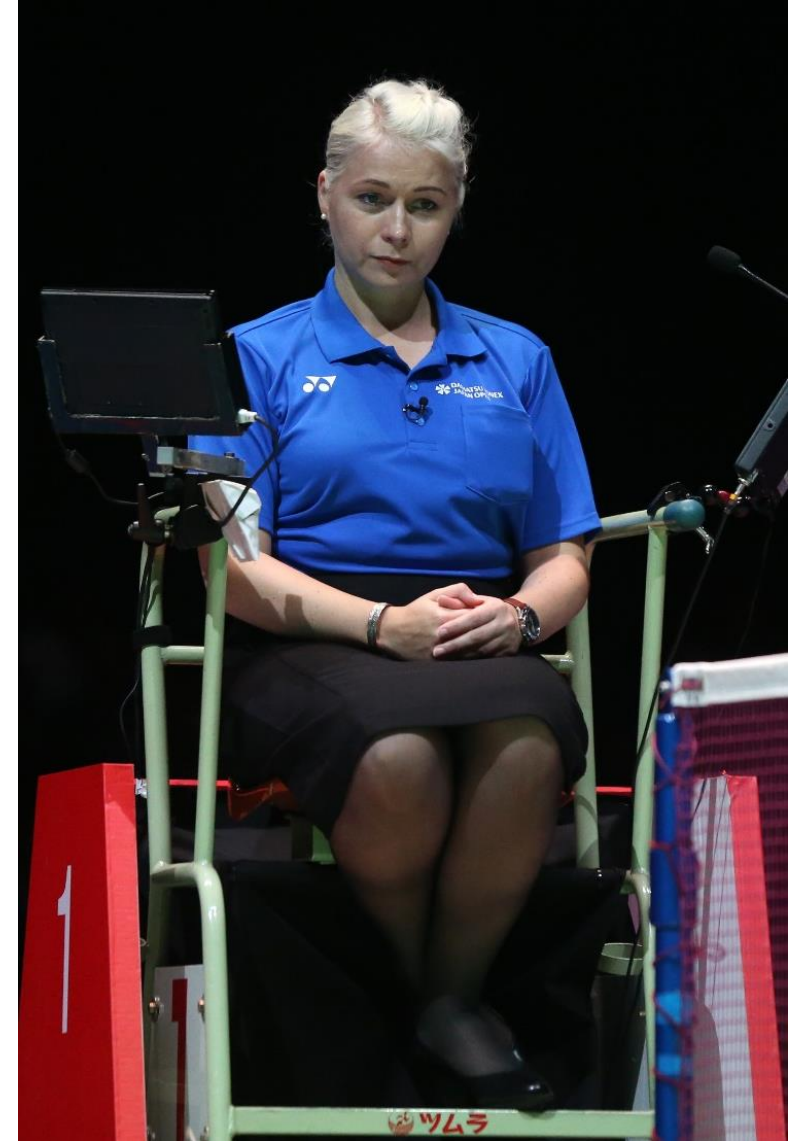
Before the Match - On Court

- ◀ Sit up straight in the umpire's chair.
- ◀ Do not cross your legs or feet while sitting in the umpire's chair.



Before the Match - On Court

- ◀ If a female umpire is wearing a skirt, it is then permissible for the umpire to sit with their ankles crossed.



Before the Match - On Court

- ▶ If the match is being played on the TV court, wait to receive a signal on when to start each game, (if instructed by the referee), to ensure to start at the correct time.
- ▶ Before going on court, confirm if intervals are mandatory – this should have been addressed at the Umpires' Briefing.

Start of the Match

- ▶ Do not start the announcement before the players finish their practice serves and they are in their respective courts, ready to play.
- ▶ In singles, as a part of their practice, the players may serve twice; once from each service court.
- ▶ When starting the announcements, extend your right arm, pointing it downward to indicate and announce the player(s) on your right.

Start of the Match

- ▶ Extend the left arm pointing downward to indicate and announce the player(s) on your left.
- ▶ No extension of the arm is necessary to announce which side is serving.
- ▶ While making any announcement, keep your head up.



Start of the Match

- ▶ Do not begin the announcement at the start of a match if another announcement is being made. Make sure there is a pause between “Love all” and “Play”. Only say “Play” when the players are ready.
- ▶ Delay the announcement of the score until the crowd noise subsides, unless it will delay the start of the next rally.
- ▶ All announcements must be correct, clear and audible.

During the Match

- ▶ As soon as the service is delivered, have a quick look at the service judge. Sometimes, the noise of the spectators can be very loud, so that is the only way to know if a service fault has been called.
- ▶ After a quick look at the service judge, follow the shuttle in play.

During the Match

- ▶ When writing the score onto your scoresheet, it should be done quickly so that the umpire is looking at the court and players most of the time.
- ▶ Do exactly the same, if an electronic scorepad is being used.



During the Match

- ▶ Have a quick look at the scoring device located at ends of the court in between rallies to be sure scores are correct.
- ▶ If it is wrong, correct it immediately , or if this cannot be done quickly, ensure the players know that it is no longer being used, and inform the referee.
- ▶ Ensure there is no undue delay in announcing the score after each rally.

During the Match

Change of shuttle

- ▶ If both players agree, acknowledge the change of shuttle by nodding your head, indicating «yes» or extend an open hand towards the service judge.
- ▶ If one player does not want to change the shuttle, the umpire needs to give a decision, without asking to see the shuttle. Note that a player, whether serving or receiving, may ask for a shuttle change.

During the Match

- ▶ Players should not test a shuttle without the umpire's permission.
- ▶ Testing of new (replacement) rackets on court should be prevented. If necessary, Law 16.7 could be applied.
- ▶ The umpire should follow the referee's instruction at the main Umpires' Briefing with regard to tipping or changing the speed of the shuttle.

During the Match

- ◀ If mopping is needed, say “Wipe the court, please”.
- ◀ Do not point to the spot but get the player(s) to indicate where the court needs mopping.
- ◀ During mopping, allow the players to towel down or have a drink, if the situation permits.
- ◀ Players should be back on-court as soon as mopping is finished and before the court attendants leave the court.

During the Match

- ◀ It is permitted for players to have a quick towel down between rallies, provided there is no delay of play.
- ◀ Ensure that one side is not allowed to be consistently slow in preparing to serve or receive.
- ◀ Informally (or formally if flagrant) warn players where there is:
 - Undue delay in play;
 - Throwing sweat onto the court surface;
 - Leaving the court without permission, except during intervals.

During the Match

- ◀ Listen carefully to a request/complaint and make a quick decision.
- ◀ Call loudly and authoritatively (even if nervous) at all times.
- ◀ Make clear any decision by using the relevant call/vocabulary (e.g. "You touched the net" or "Change the shuttle"), and where appropriate, use clear and firm gestures.
- ◀ Sit alertly in the chair.

During the Match

- ▶ If the umpire disagrees with a line call, the umpire should immediately overrule the call by saying "Correction IN" or "Correction OUT" followed by "Service over" as appropriate, then announce the new score.
- ▶ Where IRS is in use, any challenge made by a player must be done immediately.

During the Match

- ◀ Vocabulary that must be used for result(s) of IRS challenge:
 - Challenge successful then call "Correction IN" or "Correction OUT" (as appropriate) followed by "Service over" as appropriate, then the score, and finally call "Play".
 - Challenge unsuccessful then call "Challenge unsuccessful" "One or no (as appropriate) challenge(s) remaining". "Service over" as appropriate, then the score, and finally call "Play".

During the Match

- ◀ If the result of a challenge is “No decision” then the original, challenged decision stands.
- ◀ If following a call of “Unsighted”, by a line judge, IRS gives “No decision” then a “Let” shall be played.

During the Match

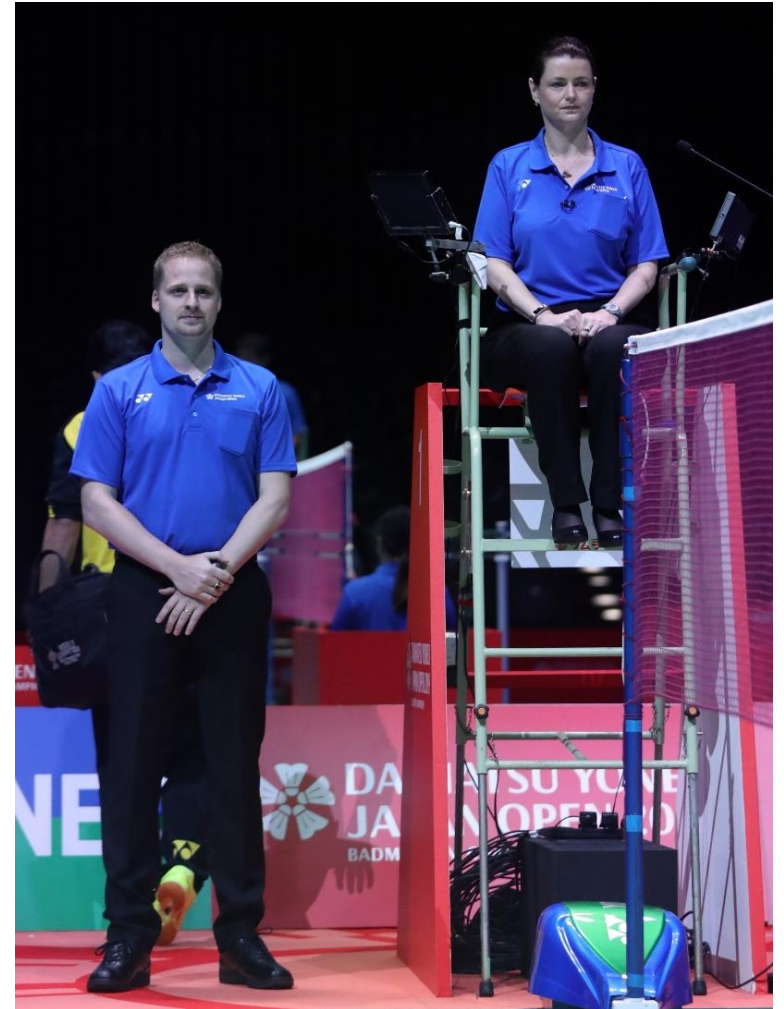
- ▶ A player should not be allowed to influence any line calls, whether by call or gesture.
- ▶ A player should not be allowed to protest/dispute a call or argue with a line judge without an informal warning, at the least.

During the Match - Intervals

- ▶ At the intervals, immediately after announcing the score, request for mopping of the court – do not waste time as there are often feathers and sweat on the court.
- ▶ During intervals, at the end of a game, do not ask players in doubles who is going to serve or receive in the next game, and you should not assume that it will be the same as it was in the previous game.
- ▶ Note that the interval is there for coaching purposes. Best practice – identify server/ receiver by observing their positions only.

During the Match - Intervals

- ▶ During the two-minute interval, at the end of a game, the service judge walks to the umpire's chair, stands beside it facing the court.
- ▶ If the umpire or the area around the umpire's chair is wired with microphones for the media, be careful what is discussed with the service judge or player(s) any time during/after a match.



During the Match - Intervals

- ◀ Manage the interval time correctly.
- ◀ During the intervals, always be aware of where the players are. Speak to the player(s) if the coach is not leaving the courtside after "20 seconds" is called.
- ◀ Also be aware of possible "Service Court Errors" after a break in play, e.g. intervals, toweling down and change of ends.

After the Match - On Court

- ▶ Immediately following the last rally of the game, call "Game".
- ▶ Make sure to record the end time of the match.
- ▶ The announcement at the end of a match must be done after the umpire and the service judge shake hands with the players.
- ▶ Smile if appropriate.



After the Match - On Court

- ▶ After the final announcement, get out of the umpire's chair as soon as possible, and with the service judge, walk to the exit point of the court.
- ▶ Wait with the service judge at the exit point of the court for the other officials; line judges and court attendants, and then exit the court and FOP as a team.

After the Match - Off Court

- ◀ Thanking of court officials at the end of a match should be done after exiting the court and FOP.
- ◀ Complete the scoresheet, if a paper (hard copy) has been used, after leaving the court. (e.g. adding up the shuttles used, time elapsed for the match, etc.)

After the Match - Off Court

- ▶ If a warning and/or fault has been called during the match, report the details at the bottom or back of the scoresheet, and advise the referee accordingly.
- ▶ As quickly as possible, have your scoresheet signed by the referee.
- ▶ If an electronic scorepad has been used, then only collect the printed scoresheet if incident(s) have occurred, which has to be brought to the referee's attention.



BWF

Instructions to Service Judges

Before the Match - On Court

- ◀ It is no longer necessary for the net to be measured before the start of a match.
- ◀ Should the net appear to be low, the arena staff can be called to adjust the net height, preferably during intervals.

Before the Match - On Court

- ▶ Do not cross legs or feet while sitting in the service judge's chair.
- ▶ Hands should be rested in front, in a comfortable position.
- ▶ If a female umpire is wearing a skirt, it is then permissible for the service judge to sit with ankles crossed.



Before the Match

- On Court

- ▶ Do not hand out warm up shuttles until all players have exercised their choice(s) arising from the toss.
- ▶ Do not keep the tube of shuttles or hold a shuttle in your hand(s) during the match.
- ▶ Place the tube next to the service judge's chair and only pull out a shuttle when it is needed.

During the Match

- ▶ Always receive the used shuttle before issuing a new one to the player who is serving.
- ▶ If shuttles need to be tipped – do so discreetly and have no more than two or three ready for use. Do not tip the entire tube.



During the Match

- ◀ When watching the server, do not follow the shuttle to the other side.
- ◀ The service judge should keep eyes on the server for a short moment after the serve has been delivered - to see if the serve is legal, then look at the umpire (eye contact), after that the service judge may follow the shuttle in play.

During the Match

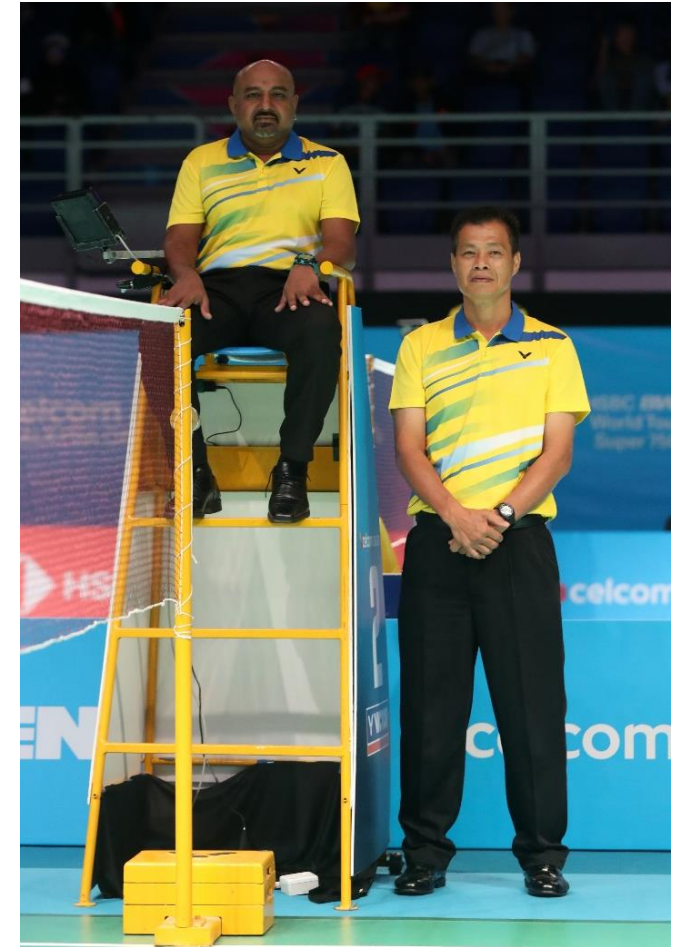
- ◀ When calling a service fault, the “Fault” should be called loudly with the appropriate signal being made and held long enough for the umpire and players to see.
- ◀ Normally a player should not go to the service judge after a service fault call. The player must ask the umpire’s permission to speak to the service judge.

During the Match

- ◀ Work as a team with the umpire. Discreetly assist the umpire with line calls, double hits, keeping score, etc.
- ◀ At the end of each game, wait for the announcement to be completed before standing up.

During the Match - Intervals

- ▶ Wait until the umpire announces the result of the game (being first or second) before standing up, walk to place the interval indicator (if one is used) in the middle of court under the net and then go and stand beside the umpire's chair, facing your chair on the side of the referee's table, unless advised differently.
- ▶ Only speak with the umpire if it is necessary.
- ▶ At all mid-game intervals, the service judge should remain seated in the chair.



After the Match - On Court

- ▶ At the end of a match, stand up as soon as the umpire calls “game”. Watch the players on court to make sure there is no problem so that you are ready to help the umpire if necessary.
- ▶ Do not shake hands while sitting in the chair. Smile if appropriate.
- ▶ Do not place one or two shuttles mid-court under the net at the end of a match, unless instructed by the referee.
- ▶ Once the umpire has made the final announcement, walk across the court to join the umpire, to leave the court.

Instructions to Umpires & Service Judges

- Refrain from being too friendly with players.
- Refrain from commenting on players on social media.
- All these instructions are of course subject to any specific directions given by referees at the Umpire's Briefing(s).

